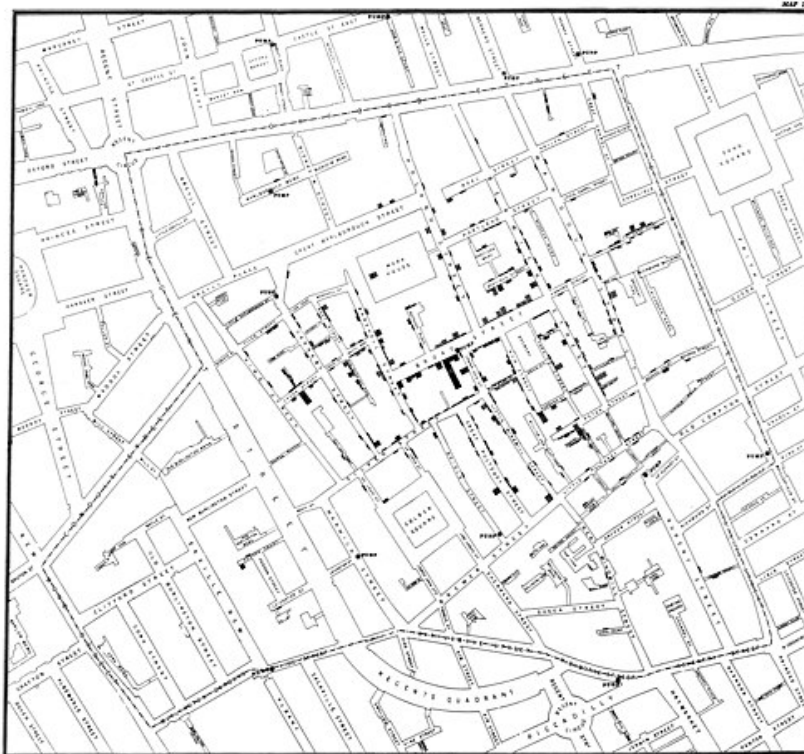




THE HISTORY PORTAL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

WHY DID IT TAKE SO LONG TO CLEAN UP BRITAIN?

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
Lesson / Assessment Title		Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: How much progress did the Romans make in public health?				
L2: Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?				
L3: To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?				
L4: How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?				
L5: Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?				
Assessment: End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: How much progress did the Romans make in public health?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Describe the simple, practical sanitation methods used by Iron Age Britons.

☐ Explain how Roman engineers introduced revolutionary sanitation technology.

☐ Evaluate the significance of Roman bathhouses and latrines for public health.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

What does AD stand for in historical dates?

What century is the year 1066 in?

Which ancient empire conquered Britain and built Hadrian's Wall?

What does the word 'Sanitation' mean?

What is a primary source?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

Aqueduct | Conduit | Hypocaust | Latrine | Cesspit | Strigil

Q1. Identify how Iron Age communities managed their waste.

Q2. Describe the purpose of Roman conduits and aqueducts.

Q3. Using Source A (the communal latrines at Housesteads Fort), explain how this source demonstrates both the advancements and limitations of Roman sanitation.

Q4. Based on what you have learned about Roman sanitation, why do you think a wealthy palace like Fishbourne would have its own private bathhouse and hypocaust system, while ordinary Romano-British people did not?

Q5. How does the archaeological evidence at Fishbourne support the idea that elite Romans valued hygiene and comfort?

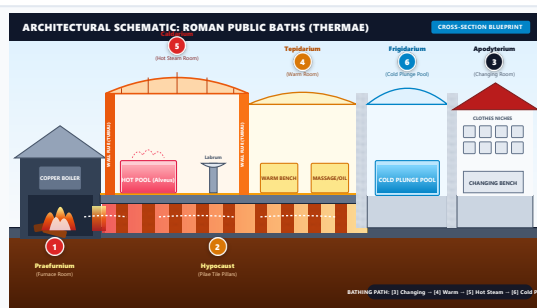
Q6. Explain how bathhouses and latrines improved public health in Roman towns.

Q7. According to Seneca, what does this source reveal about the social and commercial atmosphere inside a Roman bathhouse?

Q8. Visual Blueprint: Anatomy of a Roman Public Bathhouse (Thermae)

VISUAL ANATOMY

Study the architectural cross-section diagram of a Roman public bathhouse. Identify each numbered engineering feature and explain its purpose in Roman hygiene.



Schematic cross-section of Roman Thermae showing furnace heat flow beneath hypocaust floors and through wall flue tiles (tubuli).

1 Praefurnium (The Furnace Chamber)

Identify feature [1] and explain how heat was generated for the baths.

The Praefurnium was the furnace chamber where...

2 Hypocaust (Underfloor Heating Pillars)

Identify feature [2] and explain how the raised floor circulated heat.

The Hypocaust worked by circulating hot air beneath...

3 Apodyterium (Changing Room & Clothes Niches)

Identify feature [3] and explain what bathers did upon entering.

The Apodyterium was the entrance room where bathers...

4 Tepidarium (Warm Transition Room)

Identify feature [4] and explain why bathers spent time here before the hot bath.

The Tepidarium was a warm transition room where...

5 Caldarium (Hot Steam Room & Alveus Pool)

Identify feature [5] and explain the cleaning process inside this room.

The Caldarium was the hottest room where bathers...

6 Frigidarium (Cold Plunge Pool)

Identify feature [6] and explain why bathers finished their routine here.

The Frigidarium was an unheated cold pool used to...

Q9. Evaluate the impact of the Roman withdrawal on Britain's sanitation.

Pair & Share Activity

Q10. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why would the Romans spend so much money on public health?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Simon Schama argues: *"The Romans were the first to provide their citizens with the basic requirements of public health. Rather than just building spectacular temples, they poured staggering amounts of money, engineering brilliance, and state resources into aqueducts, public bathhouses, and flushing latrines. It was not merely about hygiene, but about Roman identity; to be 'Roman' meant participating in the civilized, communal bathing culture that separated them from the so-called 'barbarians'. However, we must be careful not to overstate this progress: while the wealthy enjoyed luxurious private hypocausts, the vast majority of ordinary citizens still lived in crowded, smoke-filled insulae, sharing public latrines that were breeding grounds for intestinal parasites."*

Q11. According to Schama, was Roman public health purely about stopping disease, or was there another motivation?

Writing Practice

Q12. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.

PEE/PEEL Structure Strip & Hints:

- Mention aqueducts.
- Mention public baths.

General Notes

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Describe the simple cesspits used by peasants in rural Medieval villages.

☐ Explain why Medieval monasteries built complex water systems.

☐ Evaluate the role of gongfermers and night-work in medieval towns.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

How did the Romans transport massive amounts of fresh water?

What did the Romans use to flush their public toilets?

Why did the Roman army need to stay healthy?

What did the Romans build in their forts to treat sick soldiers?

Did the Romans understand bacteria?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

Gongfermer | Miasma Theory | Monastery | Leat | Privy | Black Death (1348)

Q1. Identify the main method of waste disposal in medieval villages like Wharram Percy.

Q2. Describe the sanitation facilities found in medieval monasteries like Canterbury Priory.

Q3. What does this highly detailed plumbing plan suggest about the role of monasteries in preserving public health during the Medieval era?

Q4. How does the water management system at Titchfield Abbey support the idea that monasteries were much healthier places to live than Medieval towns?

Q5. Explain why overcrowded medieval towns faced a filtration crisis.

Q6. Explain the role of gongfermers in medieval towns.

Q7. Evaluate the significance of Edward III's cleanliness mandate in 1349.

Pair & Share Activity

Q8. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Who had better public health, a Roman soldier or a Medieval monk?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Carole Rawcliffe argues: *"Medieval towns were not entirely filthy; many had local laws requiring citizens to clean the street outside their house."*

Q9. How does Rawcliffe challenge the idea that all medieval towns were completely disgusting?

Writing Practice

Q10. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.

PEE/PEEL Structure Strip & Hints:

- Mention the lack of sewers.
- Mention what people believed caused disease (miasma).

General Notes

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Describe the sanitation problems in growing Tudor and Stuart towns.

☐ Explain why early flushing toilets like Sir John Harington's failed to catch on.

☐ Evaluate how Samuel Pepys's diary reveals the reality of Early Modern sanitation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Why were medieval towns dangerous for public health?

What was a Gongfermer?

Why did medieval monks build clean water systems?

What is a cesspit?

What did King Edward III order in 1357?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

Water Closet (1596) | Conduit System | Scavenger | Great Plague of 1665 | Night Soil | Urbanisation

Power, Governance & Warfare

Economy, Trade & Society

Q1. Identify who invented the first flushing water closet.

Q2. Why do you think this brilliant invention failed to catch on in Early Modern Britain despite its obvious sanitary benefits?

Q3. Describe the purpose of the New River project in 1613.

Q4. If you lived in the overcrowded, walled town of Tudor Portsmouth, what risks would you face from the lack of proper sewers and overflowing cesspits?

Q5. Explain what Samuel Pepys' diary reveals about Early Modern privies.

Q6. Evaluate the effectiveness of Early Modern water sellers for public health.

Pair & Share Activity

Q7. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why didn't Sir John Harington's flush toilet become popular instantly?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Roy Porter argues: *"The rapid growth of London meant that traditional methods of waste disposal simply could not cope."*

Q8. What does Porter say was the main reason towns became so filthy?

Writing Practice

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why the growth of towns (urbanisation) made public health worse in the Early Modern period.

PEE/PEEL Structure Strip & Hints:

- Mention overcrowding.
- Mention the amount of waste produced.

General Notes

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L4: How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Describe the overcrowded and unhygienic conditions of industrial back-to-back housing.

☐ Explain how Edwin Chadwick argued for public health reform in his 1842 report.

☐ Evaluate Dr. John Snow's discovery that cholera was waterborne.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Why did rivers in early modern towns become open sewers?

Who invented a working flushing toilet in 1596?

Why did Harington's flushing toilet fail to catch on for 250 years?

What does 'urbanisation' mean?

How did early modern townspeople get their drinking water?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Laissez-faire | Cholera (1831) | Back-to-back Housing | Cesspool Overflow | Edwin Chadwick | Public Health Act 1848

Challenge: Write ONE statement containing a deliberate historical misconception using **Laissez-faire** or **Cholera (1831)**. Swap with a partner to identify and correct the error:

Q1. Identify two effects of the industrial population surge on factory towns.

Q2. Describe the living conditions in industrial back-to-back housing.

Q3. Why did rapid population growth in places like Portsea make the 1849 cholera outbreak so devastating for the local community?

Q4. Explain how the cholera epidemics forced the government to act.

Q5. How did Dr. Snow use this map to challenge the prevailing 'miasma' theory of disease?

Q6. Evaluate the significance of Edwin Chadwick's 1842 report.

Pair & Share Activity

Q7. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was it fair for the government to follow a 'laissez-faire' attitude?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Steven Johnson argues: *"John Snow's map of the Broad Street cholera outbreak was a triumph of medical detective work."*

Q8. Why does Johnson call Snow's work 'detective work'?

Writing Practice

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why John Snow's discovery at the Broad Street pump was a turning point.

PEE/PEEL Structure Strip & Hints:

- Explain what people used to believe (miasma).
- Explain what Snow proved about water.

General Notes

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L5: Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Describe the events of the Great Stink in 1858.
☐ Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system transformed London.
☐ Evaluate how Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory revolutionized our understanding of disease.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

What was the 'laissez-faire' attitude?

What terrifying waterborne disease first struck Britain in 1831?

What scientific theory did doctors wrongly believe caused disease?

How did Dr. John Snow prove cholera was waterborne?

Who published a damning report on sanitary conditions in 1842?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

The Great Stink (1858) | Sir Joseph Bazalgette | Intercepting Sewers | River Thames | Germ Theory (1861) | Public Health Act 1875

Q1. Identify what John Snow's Broad Street map proved about cholera.

Q2. Describe the impact of the Great Stink on Parliament in 1858.

Q3. How did the construction of the Eastney Beam Engine House in 1887 solve the exact same public health crisis in Portsmouth that Bazalgette solved in London?

Q4. Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system solved London's waste problem.

Q5. What does the sheer scale of this brickwork reveal about the Victorian government's response to the Great Stink of 1858?

Q6. Explain the link between Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory and sanitation.

Q7. Evaluate the significance of the 1875 Public Health Act for modern sanitation.

Pair & Share Activity

Q8. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: What finally forced Parliament to act?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

The Observer Newspaper, 1861 argues: "*Bazalgette's sewer system was the most extensive and wonderful work of modern times.*"

Q9. How did the media at the time view Bazalgette's sewers?

Writing Practice

Q10. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.

PEE/PEEL Structure Strip & Hints:

- Mention the removal of sewage.
- Mention the end of cholera epidemics.

General Notes

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

What Roman engineering structure carried fresh water across valleys into towns?

What was a medieval worker who cleared cesspits at night called?

What incorrect theory claimed that foul smells and poisonous air caused disease?

In what year did Asiatic cholera first strike Britain?

What 1858 environmental crisis forced Parliament to fund London's new sewer system?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

Dr John Snow | Broad Street Pump | Waterborne Disease | Epidemiological Mapping | Miasma Myth | Public Health Reform

Q1. Explain why the medical establishment initially refused to believe cholera was waterborne in 1854.

Q2. How did John Snow's investigation of the brewery workers strengthen his hypothesis?

Q3. Explain the long-term significance of John Snow's work for modern public health.

General Notes

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Water & Sanitation Through Time

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)